

**Purpose:** To help us recognize the importance of living according to the doctrines of the gospel and receiving priesthood ordinances. †1. Switch Points—President Gordon B. Hinckley  
How could such a small change have such a significant effect on the location of the train?  
What are some potential switch points in our lives?

### 1. Husbands’ and wives’ relationships with each other and with the Lord

• Read and discuss [1 Corinthians 11:1-3, 11-12](#).

Why do you think Paul included all of these relationships together?

What qualities exist in the relationship between Jesus Christ and his Father? (See [John 17:21-22](#).)

How can husbands develop these qualities in their relationship?

What does it mean, “neither is the man without the woman, neither the woman without the man, in the Lord”?

Why is the relationship of husband and wife so important in the kingdom of God?

In what ways should husbands and wives treat each other?

†2. President Marion G. Romney †3. Stephen R. Covey

How can our marital relationships become positive or negative switch points in our lives?

### 2. The purpose of the sacrament

• Read and discuss [1 Corinthians 11:17-29](#). †4. Saints in Corinth

• 1 Cor. 11:20, FN: 20b. JST—“Is it not to eat the Lord’s supper?” †5. Elder Jeffrey R. Holland

• 1 Cor. 11:23-26. Jesus said, “Take eat: this is my body, which is broken for you: this do in remembrance of me.”

• 1 Cor. 11:27-31. “For he that eateth and drinketh unworthily, eateth and drinketh damnation to himself”.

What are some ways we may partake of the sacrament unworthily?

Why is examining our worthiness an important part of the sacrament? †6. Self-examination, Self-confrontation

How can we make this ordinance more meaningful in our lives?

How can our attitude toward the sacrament be a switch point in our lives?

### 3. The importance of all spiritual gifts

• Read and discuss [1 Corinthians 12-14](#). †7. Elder Bruce R. McConkie

• 1 Cor. 14:2-14, 27-28. “But he that prophesieth speaketh unto to men to edification, exhortation, and comfort.”

• 1 Cor. 12:7-11; [Moroni 10:8-17](#); [D&C 46:11-33](#). “For to one is given by the Spirit the word of wisdom”.

What are some gifts named in the scriptures listed above?

How have these gifts blessed you or others?

• 1 Cor. 12:31; [D&C 46:8](#). “That ye may not be deceived seek ye earnestly the best gifts, always remembering” why.

• 1 Cor. 14:12; [D&C 46:9](#). For “the edifying of the church,” and “not for a sign”.

“To edify is to build up, instruct, improve, and enlighten.” (*Lesson Manual*)

• 1 Cor. 13:1-3, 8-11. “8 Charity never faileth”.

• 1 Cor. 13:4-7. “Charity suffereth long, and is kind, charity envieth not; charity vaunteth not itself, is not puffed up.”

What does each one of these attributes mean? How can we apply them in our lives?

Why is charity more important than any other spiritual gift? †8. Elder Bruce R. McConkie

How can we develop greater charity? (See [Moroni 7:44-48](#).)

How can the growth of charity within us act as a switch point in our lives?

### 4. Resurrection and the degrees of glory

• Read and discuss [1 Corinthians 15](#). Corinthian saints “had begun to dispute the reality of the Resurrection”. (*LM*)

• 1 Cor. 15:3-8, 12. The risen Christ “was seen of Cephas, then of the twelve: ... he was seen of above five hundred”.

Why are witnesses of the Resurrection important to you?

• 1 Cor. 15:20-23. “But now is Christ risen from the dead, and become the firstfruits of them that slept.”

• 1 Cor. 15:29. “Else what shall they do which are baptized for the dead, if the dead rise not at all? ...”

• 1 Cor. 15:40-42; [D&C 88:27-33](#); [D&C 76](#). “There are also celestial bodies, and bodies terrestrial”.

How can our convictions of the Resurrection and of the kingdoms of glory act as a switch point in our lives?

Next Week: L35 “Be Ye Reconciled to God”; See L35: [Class Member Study Guide](#).

Read the Institute New Testament Student Manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#).) † •

## NT34 Quotes

### †1. Switch Points—President Gordon B. Hinckley:

“Many years ago I worked in the head office of one of our railroads. One day I received a telephone call from my counterpart in Newark, New Jersey, who said that a passenger train had arrived without its baggage car. The patrons were angry.

“We discovered that the train had been properly made up in Oakland, California, and properly delivered to St. Louis, from which station it was to be carried to its destination on the east coast. But in the St. Louis yards, a thoughtless switchman had moved a piece of steel just three inches. That piece of steel was a switch point, and the car that should have been in Newark, New Jersey, was in New Orleans, Louisiana, thirteen hundred miles away” (“[Watch the Switches in Your Life](#),” *Ensign*, Jan. 1973, 91).

†2. **President Marion G. Romney:** “[A husband and wife] should be one in harmony, respect, and mutual consideration. Neither should plan or follow an independent course of action. They should consult, pray, and decide together. ... Remember that neither the wife nor the husband is the slave of the other. Husbands and wives are equal partners” (“[In the Image of God](#),” *Ensign*, Mar. 1978, 2, 4).

†3. **Stephen R. Covey:** “When we love God and Christ first, we will love our spouse more, not less—with more true love, more wisdom, and more charity... Divine-centeredness is literally the key to a celestial relationship... [I]f we are true and faithful to the covenants we make with the Lord, we will have the security, guidance, wisdom, and power to deal with problems in the marriage.” (*The Divine Center*; [Salt Lake City, Utah: Bookcraft, 1982] 90-91.)

†4. **Saints in Corinth:** “Many of the Saints in Corinth were not observing the purpose of the sacrament service. Instead of focusing on the sacrament ordinance, they were contending with each other and eating and drinking to excess (1 Corinthians 11:18-22).” (*Lesson Manual*)

†5. **Elder Jeffrey R. Holland:** “With so very much at stake, [the sacrament] should be taken more seriously than it sometimes is. It should be a powerful, reverent, reflective moment. It should encourage spiritual feelings and impressions. As such it should not be rushed. It is not something to ‘get over’ so that the real purpose of sacrament meeting can be pursued. This is the real purpose of the meeting” (“[This Do in Remembrance of Me](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1995, 68).

†6. **Self-examination, Self-confrontation:** “First is *Self-confrontation*. This involves recognizing that a sin has been committed and that repentance is needed. Also, experiencing sorrow or remorse, making confession, and suffering the consequences of having broken the moral law are involved.

...  
“*Self-confrontation* seems difficult for many of us. It requires understanding how we avoid the truth about ourselves and what is needed to overcome that avoidance. It is said that we must recognize our errors, feel remorse or sorrow, and make confession; but this creates an immediate threat to our self-image—and by nature we tend to protect ourselves from full disclosure of our faults or, when exposed, to justify or rationalize our misconduct.” (Alan E. Bergin, Ph.D Clinical Psychology, “[Psychology and Religion](#),” BYU Speeches, Oct. 04, 1994.)

†7. **Elder Bruce R. McConkie:** “If the saints are to be saved, they must accept, understand, and experience the gifts of the Spirit. Since religion itself is of the Spirit, and deals with spiritual things, it can be received and known only by the power of the Spirit. Thus where the gifts of the Spirit are manifest, there is true religion; and where the gifts of the Spirit are not manifest, there true religion is not.” (*Doctrinal New Testament Commentary*, 2:366)

†8. **Elder Bruce R. McConkie:** “Above all the attributes of godliness and perfection, charity is the one most devoutly to be desired. Charity is more than love, far more; it is everlasting love, perfect love, the pure love of Christ which endureth forever. It is love so centered in righteousness that the possessor has no aim or desire except for the eternal welfare of his own soul and for the souls of those around him.” (*Mormon Doctrine*, 121)

### Recommended Reading:

1. [NT34 Enrichment.pdf](#) contains more quotes and links to articles, blogs, and talks.

2. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, [Chapter 39: 1 Corinthians 12-14](#), [Scroll down to Acts 18:23. Commencement of Paul’s Third Missionary Journey.](#)

3. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, [Chapter 40: 1 Corinthians 15-16](#).

4. Elder Boyd K. Packer, “[Language of the Spirit](#),” *Ensign*, March 1977.

Visit [stephenmbird.com](http://stephenmbird.com)